

obsolete. The new era requires much higher resolutions, so that the picture remains sharp on a large screen. Enter HDTV. Broadcasted at far higher resolutions than standard television (the highest being 1920x1080, a resolution supported in Windows only on high end graphics cards), HDTV has already captured a sizeable portion of the market. Many channels today broadcast in HDTV, while many countries are quickly trying to set up HDTV standards.

From being an essential service for news and general awareness, the radio is now popularly regarded as a means of entertainment

As the primary mode of entertainment for the majority of the population, television continues to dominate. With continuous improvements in both image and audio quality, this trend is expected to continue for the foreseeable future.

3.2 Radio broadcasting

Despite the popularity of television and the widespread availability of the internet, broadcast radio tenaciously clings onto a sizeable audience. Some say the attractiveness is in its inherent simplicity and reliability; some attribute it to the fact that entertainment in the audio form dominates the audio industry. Whatever may be the case, any discussion on the topic of wireless broadcasting will remain incomplete without the mention of broadcast radio.

With the exception of internet radio and cable radio, both of which we will not deal with here, all audio transmissions occur wirelessly over radio waves. Radio broadcasting stations of every type, commercial, non-profit, public, private, etc., can be found in all parts of the globe. Some are even run by students on campuses, while some are for emergency utilisation by police, etc.

The majority of radio broadcast stations today can be classified into two: AM and FM.

AM, standing for amplitude modulation (a technique for converting audio signals into transmittable radio waves, explained earlier) is the older and simpler of the two. Although fast being eclipsed by the popularity of FM and internet radio, AM continues to be popular due to its high range (often extending to thousands of kilometres at night). In India, All